

ZTE shutdown Kickstarter

After about two months, ZTE is closing down their Hawkeye phone kickstarter due to insufficient funds. <http://dgit.in/HawkeyeZTE>

**Ms Office for Mac**

Microsoft releases an update for its Office suite that adds support for Apple's new MacBook Pro Touch Bar feature. <http://dgit.in/TouchMs>

WD Green SSD 240 GB

Pales in comparison to the WD Blue



The WD Green 240 GB SSD which is targeted at the budget segment.

Currently available with just two capacities, a 120 GB and 240 GB SKU.

Anything greater and it's unlikely that you'd want the controller that the WD Green comes with and you'll soon know why.

Unlike the WD Blue which had a Marvell 88SS1074 controller, the WD Green features a Silicon Motion SM2258XT which isn't that big a surprise. A glance at the PCB and we notice that the SM2258XT has a RAM-less design.

Both halves of the body are made of plastic with just metal inserts at the screw holes. The controller doesn't have any heatsink



Price
₹8,320

or thermal pads attached to it. And even if it did, the body isn't made of metal to act as a heatsink. Here's where the power efficiency comes into play, as a controller which consumes less power isn't going to heat up as much.

We ran CrystalDiskMark before conditioning the SSDs and the sequential read speeds were at 540 MBps and write speeds were at 458 MBps. Compared to the WD Blue, the read speeds seem to be the same but the write speeds are 11.6 per cent lower.

We decided to compare the latency timings of the WD Green and the WD Blue. And the results are surprising. For something that costs just ₹1,200 lesser than the WD Blue, the WD Green sure has a large performance gap. The latency timings are roughly double that of the WD Blue and there's a large jump from 16QD onwards.

The WD Green 240 GB SSD suffers in comparison to its blue coloured cousin so we'd advise you to go for the WD Blue instead.

Mithun Mohandas



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Build	65
Value for Money	86

Specifications

Model: WDS240G1G0A; **Form factor:** 2.5-inch; **Cost/GB:** ₹34.7; **Dimensions:** 100.5 x 69.9 x 7 mm; **Controller:** SM2258XT; SanDisk 15 nm TLC; **Warranty:** 3 years

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Asus Zenfone 3s Max

Lasts long, but not the best

Battery life and update frequency are two major issues plaguing Android smartphones today. Think of the long list of smartphones available, and you'll realise so few of them are on Nougat.

It is this problem that Asus is addressing with its newest device. The Asus Zenfone 3s Max has a 5000 mAh battery and comes with Android Nougat out-of-the-box. To its credit the phone returns an excellent PCMark battery score of over 14 hours. The Zenfone 3s Max is also above average in terms of idle battery drop, which is important for a phone that has to last long. It runs on Android Nougat, layered with a new version of Asus' ZenUI. It looks the same aesthetically

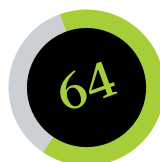


Price
₹14,999

and frustrating as ever. On the performance front the Zenfone 3s Max is far from prodigious. It runs on the MediaTek MT6750T octa-core SoC and 3GB of RAM and its performance is not the best. You can check out the exact benchmark scores in our full review online but it's suffice to say that the phone is slow – whether it be gaming, fingerprint scanning, or even opening apps. Zenfone 3s Max's camera is decent, but it doesn't make for the best you can buy. With the right pricing, this camera may be acceptable, but phones like the Honor 6x beat it.

Overall the Asus Zenfone 3s Max is a decent battery-centric smartphone, and it does last long. However, at ₹14,999, the compromises make little sense. The Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 offers just an hour or so lesser battery life and gives you a better camera and performance.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Screen: 5.2-inch (720 x 1280) IPS PPI: 282; **Camera:** 13 MP rear; **Battery:** 5000 mAh; **SoC:** Mediatek MT6750 Octacore (1.5 GHz); **RAM:** 3GB; **GPU:** Mali T860; **Storage:** 32GB (upto 2TB); **Weight:** 175gms

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